



AMD Fury unleashed

As if one GPU like the AMD Fury was not enough, AMD creates a Duo version to rival the likes of Nvidia Titan Z. <http://dgit.in/AMDProDuo>

AlphaGo loses

The DeepMind AI finally loses in AlphaGo to Lee-Se Dol bringing the final score to 1-3 making it more interesting to follow. <http://dgit.in/GoLoser>

Bazaar

Samsung Galaxy S7 Edge

Along came the best

For Samsung, the year 2016 is more about refinement than innovation. Samsung took all the feedback it got about the original Edge devices and refined its design, while adding slight improvements that make for the best Android phone in the market today. That said, there is still room for improvement in this device, starting with the fact that Samsung still needs developers to create apps for its Edge display. It's quite disappointing that after a full year, there are still no good apps to use with it.

From a design standpoint, the Galaxy S7 Edge has everything that the S6 Edge Plus didn't. Despite its large display, the S7 Edge is barely bigger than the Galaxy A5, and that's saying something. The Xiaomi Mi Note Pro-like curves on the back make it more ergonomic and easier to hold, especially when picking it off a table. To complete the seamless design, Samsung has almost eliminate the camera hump, allowing the Galaxy S7 Edge to rest flat on a table.

We still have concerns about the glass back though. It's quite fingerprint intensive and at times, slippery. The last thing you'd want is to drop a phone with an Edge display.

Speaking of which, while the Edge display does add dollops of style to the device, its functionality is still quite limited. As mentioned above, there are few apps to choose from, but there are some other issues as well. For example, regular Android apps aren't made for such a display, because of which some buttons tend to be difficult to use. It creates a learning curve, but not a very steep one. Lastly, when you hold the phone in your left hand and try to reach for the Edge, your palm touches the left edge, thereby making the right edge non-responsive. It also happens sometimes when unlocking the phone using swipes.

Samsung should also work on bringing more to the Always On display. The feature is useful, but works only with some apps, meaning notifications from third party apps, like WhatsApp, don't show



Price
₹56,900

up. In addition, you can't interact with the display like in Motorola devices. Samsung has also disabled the Adoptable Storage feature in Marshmallow, which is a bummer.

From a performance point of view, the Galaxy S7 Edge is well ahead of last year's flagships. It can do 35% more frames on OpenGL 3.0-based games, than the S6 Edge could. It can go as high as 15fps on OpenGL 3.1-based games, while it starts showing frame drops on Android Extension Pack APIs. This is a tad surprising though, considering that Samsung boasts this phone for supporting newer Vulkan APIs. Of course, benchmarks are designed to tax the device to the fullest, so real world usability should differ. Sadly, there are no Vulkan-based games on Android, to test with right now.

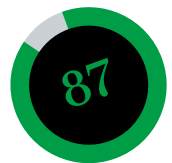
Samsung has also increased the battery capacity on the S7 Edge, from 2600 mAh last year, to 3600 mAh this year. Interestingly, the battery life seems to have gone up proportionally. We were able to get about 16.5 hours, with 6 phone calls, 30 minutes of gaming, over 20 emails, lots of IMs, three messages on Hangouts and the screen turned to full brightness (but in auto mode) along with Always On Display. With Always On turned off, the battery life increases by less than an hour.

Lastly, the camera on the Galaxy S7 Edge may be lesser in terms of megapixels, but the quality hasn't been hampered. The 12MP camera boasts a f1.7 aperture and from the firmware version, it seems like a Samsung sensor.

The dual-pixel technology has indeed allowed the Galaxy S7 Edge focus much faster under low light, compared to its predecessors, and combined with the top-class image quality, it could easily be the best camera phone in the market today.

The Samsung Galaxy S7 Edge is indeed the best Android smartphone in the market, but there's still room for improvement. And that is a good thing. This gives us hope of more striking features in the Galaxy Note 6 when it comes out later.

Prasid Banerjee



Features 90
Design 87
Performance 88
Value 77

Specifications

Processor: 2.3GHz Exynos 8890 Octa; **RAM:** 4GB DDR4; **Camera:** 12MP rear with dual-pixels, 5MP front; **Storage:** 32/64GB, expandable to 200GB; **Operating System:** Android 6.0 Marshmallow; **Battery:** 3600 mAh; **Display:** 5.5 inch QHD

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